Chapter 6: African History

Africa is the second most populated continent and second largest in land size. It is about 6% of the Earth’s overall surface total with approximately 30.3 million kilometers including its adjacent islands. It is inhabited by over 1.1 billion people who make up about 15% of the world’s population. The Mediterranean Sea surrounds Africa to the north while the Red Sea, Suez Canal, and the Sinai Peninsula are positioned in the northeast. The Indian Ocean is located to the southeast and the Atlantic Ocean lies to the west.

Within Africa, there is a broad diversity of ethnicities, cultures and languages. Africa is well known for its fantastic ancient societies and cultures. Also, this continent possesses a lot of minerals and natural resources. In the 19th century, European powers colonized most of the African continent. However, in present times, most states come from the process of decolonization that took place in the 20th century.